DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE
PANJAB UNIVERSITY, CHANDIGARH

Outlines of tests, syllabi and courses of reading in the subject of POLITICAL SCIENCE for M. Phil. Course (Semester System) for the year 2021-22

All papers are compulsory. The total credits for the M.Phil. Programme is 24 credits.

1st Semester	**Name of Paper**	**Credits:12**
Paper I	Philosophy of Social Science	4 Credits
Paper II	Methods in Social Science	4 Credits
Papers III	Reading and Writing in Social Sciences	4 Credits
2nd Semester		**Credits:12**
Paper IV	Seminar Paper	4 credits
Paper V	Dissertation	8 credits
		TotalCredits:24

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PAPER-SETTERS AND CANDIDATES

M. Phil. - Semester-I

Paper I and II

1. The question papers will consist of 60 marks each. 40 marks will be for Term Papers, Case Studies, Book Reviews related to the concerned papers.

2. The final written examination shall have 8 questions in all. The candidate is required to attempt any 4 questions carrying 15 marks each, 1 from each Unit.

Paper III

1. This paper will focus more on a system of continuous evaluation and lesson written examination. 80 marks will be for continuous evaluation through Literature Review (50), Book Review (15) and Writing Summaries/Abstracts(15).The Written Test will carry 20 marks.

2. In the written test, a candidate has to answer 2 out of 4 questions. The questions are meant to check on their critical reading skills. Each question will carry 10 marks.

M. Phil. –Semester II

Paper IV

1. The Seminar paper will consist of 100 marks out of which 75 marks shall be for the submitted seminar paper and 25 marks on the viva-voce based on the seminar paper.

Paper V

1. The dissertation will be of 200 Marks out of which 150 marks would be based on evaluation of the dissertation and 50 marks would be for viva-voce test.

M.Phil Paper1 (Compulsory)

Philosophy of Social Sciences

Note: The final written examination shall have 8 questions in all. The candidate is required to attempt any 4 questions carrying 15 marks each, 1 from each Unit.

Objective of the Course: This course aims at introducing the main themes in the philosophy of social sciences. This will familiarize them with the main debates over the nature of social science research.

Unit-I

The subject matter of Philosophy of Social Sciences
The Science Question: Is the study of society a science? Relationship with philosophy of science.
Objectivity and Value Neutrality

Unit-II
Methodological Naturalism, Positivism and Behaviouralism Laws and Explanations: Social laws, casuality and predictions Methodological Individualism and Reductionism Intentionality, Rationality and Choice

Unit-III

Interpretation and understanding: Hermeneutics and Interpretive theory of culture
Social Constructivism: Social Facts and Social Norms Structures

Unit-IV

Networks and Agency: Structuralism, Functionalism, Materialism and Post Structuralism
Stand point theory and Relativism

Readings:

Elster, Jon, (2007), *Explaining Social Behavior. More Nuts and Bolts for the Social Sciences*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Flyvbjerg, Bent, (2001), *Making Social Science Matter: Why social inquiry fails and how it cansucceed again*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Hollis, Martin, (2012), *The Philosophy of Social Sciences: An Introduction,* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Little, Daniel, (1991), *Varieties of Social Explanation,* Colorado: West view Press

Martin, Michael and McIntyre, Lee C, (1994) *Readings in the Philosophy of Social Sciences*, Cambridge: MIT Press

Rosenberg, Alex (4th ed.) (2012), *Philosophy of Social Science*, Boulder, Colorado: West view Press.

Shapiro, Ian, Smith, Rogers M and Masoud, Tarek E (eds) (2004), *Problems and Methods in the Study of Politics,* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press

Steel, Daniel & Guala, Francesco(eds.)(2011), *The Philosophy of Social Science Reade,* London: Routledge.

Turner, Stephen A and Roth, Paul A (eds.)(2003), *The Blackwell Guide to the Philosophy of the Social Sciences*, Oxford : Blackwell.

M.Phil Compulsory Paper II

Methods in Social Science

Note: The final written examination shall have 8 questions in all. The candidate is required to attempt any 4 questions carrying 15 marks each, 1 from each Unit.

Objective of the Course: This course aims at equipping students with the knowledge and skills required to undertake systematic research. On completion of this course they should be able to develop their own research topics, frame research questions, and choose appropriate methodologies for data collection and analysis.

Unit-I

Preliminaries

Design of Social Science Research
Framing Research Problem and Key Questions Concepts: Operationalisation and Measurement
Literature Review
Building Hypothesis
Selecting Case Studies
Comparative Analysis

Unit-II

Research Methods

Quantitative, Qualitative and Mixed Methods
Quantitative (Survey, Interviews and Questionnaire)

Qualitative (Ethnography, Oral narratives, Observation, Focus Group Discussion, Life Histories and Narratives)

Unit-III
Data: Types and Sources

Types of Data: Primary and Secondary

Sources of Data: Archival Sources (Documents, Diaries/Letters, Inscriptions, Photographs, Autobiographies, Paintings and Artifacts etc.), Official Statistics and Field Generated Data

Unit-IV

Data Analysis

Data preparation, Data processing, Data interpretation and analysis Quantitative Data analysis: Descriptive and Inferential statistics

Qualitative Data analysis: Discourse and Content analysis, Textual analysis

Readings

Alasuutari, Pertti, Leonard Bickman, Julia Brannen (2021), *The Sage Handbook of Social Research Methods,* London: Sage Publication.

Bhattacherjee, Anol. (2012), *Social Science Research: Principles, Methods, and Practices*. Textbooks Collection. Global Text Project.

Black, Thomas R. (1999), *Doing quantitative research in the social sciences: an integrated approach to research design, measurement and statistics,* London: Sage Publications.

Blaikie, Norman W.H. (2003), *Analyzing quantitative data: from description to explanation*, London: Sage Publications.

Brady, Henry E. (2000), *Contributions of Survey Research to Political Science, PS: Political Science and Politics.* 33(1):47-57.

Burgess, Robert G. (1984), *In the field: an introduction to field research,* Contemporary social research series, 8. London: Allen & Unwin.

Collier, David, and James E. Mahon (1993), *Conceptual "Stretching" Revisited: Adapting Categories in Comparative Analysis, American Political Science Review.* 87(4):845-855.

Creswell, W. John (2007) *Qualitative inquiry and research design: choosing among five approaches,* London: Sage Publications.

De Vaus, D.A.(2002), *Analyzing Social Science Data,* London: Sage Publications.

Denzin, Norman K., and Yvonna S. Lincoln, (2005), *The Sage Handbook of Qualitative Research,* London: Sage Publications.

Desai, Vandana, and Robert B. Potter, (2006), *Doing development research* London: Sage Publications.

Dey, Ian. (2003), *Qualitative Data Analysis: A user friendly guide for social scientists*, London: Routledge.

Eckstein, Harry, (1975) Case study and theory in political science. (eds.) Fred Greenstein and Nelson Polsby, *Handbook of Political Science*, *Volume7: Strategies of Inquiry*, Reading, MA: Addison- Wesley, 94-137.

Flyvbjerg, Bent, (2006), *Five Misunderstandings about Case-Study Research, Qualitative Inquiry*, 12 (2): 219-45.

Frank fort- Nachmias, Chava, and David Nachmias, (1996), *Research methods in the social sciences,* London: Arnold.

George L. Alexander and Andrew Bennett, (2005), *Case Studies and Theory Development in the Social Sciences* Cambridge, Massachusetts: MIT Press.

Gerring, John. 2007. *Case study research: principles and practices*. New York: Cambridge University Press.

Gerring, John, (2011), *Social Science Methodology: A Unified Framework* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Given, Lisa M., (2008), *The sage encyclopaedia of qualitative research methods,*Volumes1&2, London: Sage Publications.

Goertz, Gary (2006),*Social science concepts: a user's guide*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.

Grofman, Bernard, (2001) *Political science as puzzle solving*: *Interests, identities, and institutions in comparative politics.* Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press.

Herbert J. Rubin, (2012), *Qualitative Interviewing: The Art of Hearing Data,* Sage Publications.

Hollway, Wendy, and Tony Jefferson. 2000. *Doing qualitative research differently: free association, narrative and the interview method*. London: SAGE.

Holsti, Ole R. (1969), *Content analysis for the social sciences and humanities*, Reading, Mass: Addison- Wesley Pub. Co.

John Gerring, (2011), *Social Science Methodology: A Unified Framework,* Cambridge Publications.

Johnny Saldana, (2009), *The Coding Manual for Qualitative Researchers,* Sage Publications.

Johnson, Janet Buttolph, and Richard Joslyn, (1989), *Political science research methods,* New Delhi: Prentice- Hall of India.

Juliet M. Corbin (2014) (2nd editions) *Basics of Qualitative Research: Techniques and Procedures for Developing Grounded Theory,* Sage Publications.

King, Gary, Robert O. Keohane, and Sidney Verba, (1994), *Designing social inquiry scientific inference in qualitative research,* Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press.

Krippendorff, Klaus, (1980), *Content analysis: An Introduction to its methodology*, Beverly Hills: Sage Publications.

M. Thamilarasan, (2015), *Research Methodology for Social Sciences,* New Century Publications.

Melanie Birks, (2011), *Grounded Theory: A Practical Guide,* Sage Publications.

Miles, Matthew B., and A.M. Huberman, (1994), *Qualitative data analysis: an expanded sourcebook*, London: Sage Publications.

Mouton, Johann and H C Marais, (1990), *Basic concepts in Methodology of Social Sciences,* Pretoria: HSRC Publishers.

*Porta Donatella della and Michael Keating, (*2008), *Approaches and Methodologies in the Social Sciences: A Pluralist Perspective* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Punch, Keith and Keith Punch, (2003), *Survey research: the basics*, London: Sage Publications.

Silverman, David and Amir Marvasti (2008), *Doing Qualitative Research: A Comprehensive Guide*, London : Sage Publications.

Stephen Gorard, (2013), *Research Design: Creating Robust Approaches for the Social Sciences,* Sage Publications.

Svend Brinkmann, (2015), *Interviews: Learning the Craft of Qualitative Research Interviewing*, Sage Publications

Thomas, George, (2005), *The Qualitative Foundations of Political Science Methodology Perspectives on Politics,* 3(4):855-866.

Trochim William, (version current as of October 20, 2006), *Research methods knowledge base* (Trochim, William M. The Research Methods Knowledge Base, 2nd edition. Internet wwwpage,at url:<http://www.socialresearchmethods.net/kb/>

Van Evera, Stephen, (1997), *Guide to methods for students of political science*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press.

Weber, Robert Philip, (1990), *Basic content analysis*, London: Sage Publications.

Wright, Daniel B. (1997), *Understanding statistics: an introduction for the social sciences*. London: Sage Publications.

M.Phil Compulsory Paper 3

Reading and Writing in Social Sciences

Note: 1. In the written test, a candidate has to answer 2 out of 4 questions. The questions are meant to check on their critical reading skills. Each question will carry 10 marks.

2. 80 marks will be for continuous evaluation. The students will be evaluated on the basis of 1) Literature Review on a chosen theme (50%) 2) Test (20%) 3) Book Review (15%) 4) Writing Summary/Abstract(15%).

Objective of the Course: This course is aimed at developing critical reading and writing skills among students so that they can carry out research work.

Reading

1. Summarising the Text
2. Discerning the research question, central argument, assumptions, evidence offered
3. Extracting author's contribution to the subject area
4. Identifying gaps and problems in method, literature survey, data, approaches to the problem, interpretation

Writing

1. Choosing between formats – Structuring the paper, Elements of Organization and Presentation
2. Methodology, Sources/Data
3. Citation, References, Bibliography
4. Ethics in the Profession and Research
5. Language- Common mistakes, Sentence construction.

Readings:

Brink- Budgen, Roy van den, (1999), *Critical Thinking for Students: How to Assess Arguments and Effectively Present Your Own,* How To Books Ltd: Oxford

Mayberry, Katherine, (2009), *Everyday Arguments: A Guide to Writing and Reading Effective Arguments,* Houghton Mifflin Company*:* Boston/ NewYork

Miller, Steven I, (1999), *Teaching "Distinctions" to Undergraduates in the Philosophy of the Social Sciences*, Analytic Teaching,Vol18,No.2

Weston, Anthony, (2009), *A Rule book for Arguments,* Hackett Publishing: Indianan polis

Resources available at Purdue Online Academic Lab.
http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/section/1/2/

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